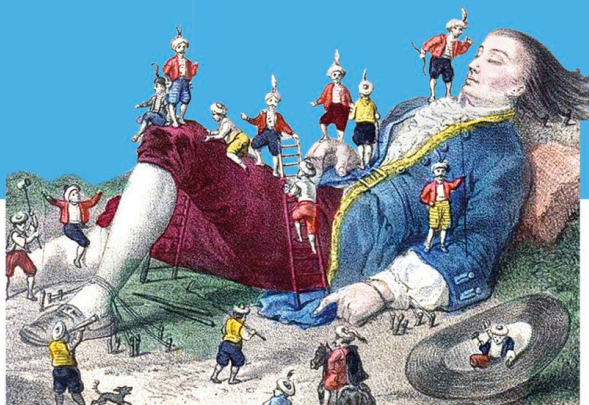




Gulliver's Travels

1726

Irish author Jonathan Swift's satirical adventure novel, *Gulliver's Travels*, was first published. It describes the fictional travels of Lemuel Gulliver, including his journey to the islands of Lilliput and Blefuscu, which are populated by tiny people.

Born this day

1955 Bill Gates, US technology entrepreneur. He established the global software giant Microsoft and became one of the world's wealthiest people. He runs a charity foundation with his former wife, Melinda Gates.

A new capital

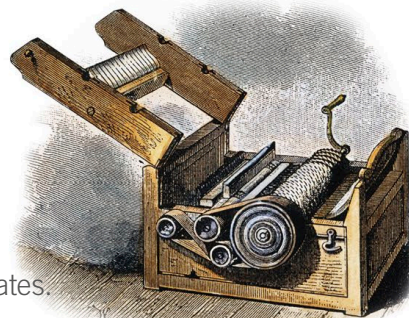
Beijing, which means "Northern Capital", was declared the capital city of the Ming Dynasty in China. At its centre was the Forbidden City, the imperial palace complex of the emperor, accessible only to the royal family and their servants.

1420

1793

Cotton gin

US inventor Eli Whitney applied for a patent for the cotton gin, a machine that quickly and easily removed cotton fibres from their seeds. The device boosted the harvesting of cotton in the country, especially in the Southern states.



Also on this day

1886 The Statue of Liberty, given to the USA as a gift from France, was dedicated in New York Harbor at a special ceremony attended by US president Grover Cleveland.

1982 The largest census in history confirmed that China was home to more than a billion people, making up almost a quarter of the world's population at that time.

